

Wildlife Institute of India



Dehradun Field Trip Report

Student	Program	Date
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NAVIGATION

Journey Overview

This report documents the academic field trip to the Wildlife Institute of India (WII) in Dehradun, undertaken as part of the second-semester curriculum of the UI/UX Design program at Graphic Era Deemed to be University.

01	Introduction & Objectives Understanding the context and goals of the field trip experience
02	Ganga River Basin Conservation Research methodologies and stakeholder engagement strategies

03	Tiger Monitoring Initiatives Advanced technologies in wildlife population tracking
04	JALAZ Aquatic Ecosystem Freshwater biodiversity and turtle conservation efforts
05	Nature Trail Experience Hands-on biodiversity observation and ecosystem study
06	Key Observations Sustainable architecture and campus design principles
07	Learning Outcomes Design thinking applications in conservation work
08	Conclusion Reflections and acknowledgments

INTRODUCTION

A Day at Wildlife Institute of India



Figure 1: Wildlife Institute of India campus with solar panels and green architecture

As part of our second-semester academic curriculum, our Design School class from **Graphic Era Deemed to be University** undertook an educational field trip to the Wildlife Institute of India (WII) in Dehradun.

The visit provided valuable insights into wildlife conservation, research methodologies, and the intersection of technology and environmental science.

"This experience enhanced our understanding of how design thinking can be applied to conservation and environmental education."

Institution	Mission
Premier research institution dedicated to wildlife conservation and research	Protecting India's natural heritage through scientific research

PURPOSE

Objectives of the Visit

Four primary goals guiding our educational journey

Research Institutions To understand the critical role of research institutions in wildlife conservation, exploring how scientific organizations contribute to protecting biodiversity and developing evidence-based conservation strategies.

- **Conservation Projects**

To learn about ongoing conservation projects and research initiatives, gaining insights into active efforts addressing environmental challenges and species protection across different ecosystems.

- **Regional Biodiversity**

To explore the natural biodiversity of the Dehradun region, observing firsthand the diverse flora and fauna that make this area ecologically significant and understanding local ecosystem dynamics.

- **Interdisciplinary Approaches**

To gain exposure to interdisciplinary approaches in environmental science, discovering how design thinking, technology, and scientific research converge to address complex conservation challenges.



Figure 2: Institute entrance featuring mature trees with moss and vegetation growth

Upon arrival at the Wildlife Institute of India, we were immediately struck by the natural beauty of the campus. The entrance features mature trees covered with moss and vegetation, demonstrating the rich biodiversity even within the institute's premises. This ecological richness sets the tone for the institute's mission of wildlife conservation and research.



Figure 3: Outdoor sitting area with crocodile sculpture and seating

The institute features thoughtfully designed outdoor spaces including sitting area with educational sculptures. A prominent Ghadiyal sculpture serves as both an artistic element and an educational tool, highlighting the importance of reptile conservation. These spaces provide venues for informal learning and interaction among students and researchers.

SESSION 1 – DR. DEEPIKA DOGRA

Ganga River Basin Conservation Project

Project Overview

The first presentation of the day was delivered by Dr. Deepika Dogra, a project scientist at WII. She presented comprehensive information about the Ganga River Basin Conservation Project, which focuses on the conservation and restoration of the Ganga River ecosystem.



Figure 4: Presentation session in the conference hall

A comprehensive initiative focusing on the **conservation and restoration** of the Ganga River ecosystem, employing scientific research methodologies to address current challenges facing one of India's most vital waterways.

WII-Jalaj Connection

- WII contributes through research on aquatic ecosystems, Ganga Praharis (community volunteers), and biodiversity hotspots—check jalajwii.com for their role in "Arth Ganga" livelihoods.
- Achievements: Reduced industrial effluents, ghat modernization, and public awareness, making your field trip's conservation talks super relevance.

Key Research Areas

- Research methodologies employed in river conservation
- Current challenges facing the Ganga River Basin
- Biodiversity assessment and monitoring techniques
- Community engagement and awareness programs
- Integration of scientific research with policy-making

Stakeholder Engagement Framework

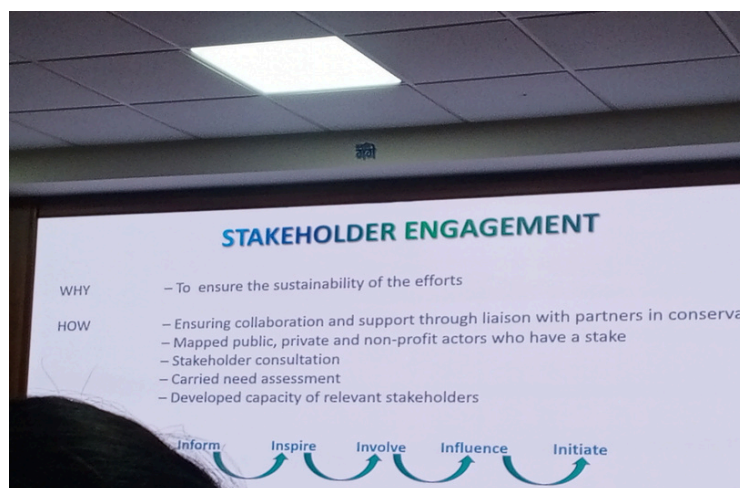


Figure 5: Stakeholder engagement framework in conservation projects

A significant portion of the presentation focused on stakeholder engagement strategies. The framework demonstrated how conservation efforts require collaboration between public, private, and non-profit actors. The five-step approach—Inform, Inspire, Involve, Influence, and Initiate—showcases how community participation is essential for sustainable conservation outcomes.

Key Insight

Conservation efforts require collaboration between public, private, and non-profit actors. Community participation is essential for sustainable conservation outcomes.

WILDLIFE TECHNOLOGY

Tiger Monitoring & Conservation

Advanced technologies protecting India's national animal

Tiger Cell at WII

The Tiger Cell plays a **crucial role in monitoring tiger populations** across India, employing cutting-edge technologies to track movements, assess population dynamics, and develop comprehensive conservation strategies.

Camera Traps 24/7 monitoring across forest corridors	GPS Tracking Real-time location and movement data
Data Analytics Pattern analysis for population insights	Long-Term Monitoring Multi-year datasets for trend detection

Academic Programs at WII

The Wildlife Institute of India offers specialized educational programs for students and professionals interested in wildlife conservation. These include diploma and certificate courses in various aspects of wildlife management, conservation biology, and environmental science. The programs are designed to build capacity in wildlife research and management across the country.

Tea Break

Following the first presentation, we had a refreshment break which provided an opportunity to interact with the faculty members and discuss various aspects of conservation work in an informal setting. This networking time was valuable for understanding the day-to-day work of conservation scientists.

JALAJ – Aquatic Ecosystem Research

Project Focus

A comprehensive project focusing on **aquatic ecosystems and freshwater biodiversity**, addressing the importance of maintaining ecological balance through research and conservation action.

Research Areas

Freshwater Species Research Systematic documentation of freshwater species diversity	Habitat Preservation Protecting critical aquatic habitats from degradation
Threat Assessment Evaluating pollution, habitat loss, and illegal trade pressures	Conservation Strategies Developing actionable plans for species and habitat protection

Project Website More information on aquatic conservation efforts, research publications, and ongoing initiatives is available at jalajwii.com

FIELD EXPERIENCE

Nature Trail: Experiencing Biodiversity

Hands-on learning in the WII campus ecosystem

Guided Trail Experience

Following the presentations, we embarked on a **guided nature trail within the WII campus**. This hands-on experience allowed us to observe the local ecosystem and biodiversity firsthand.

"The trail was both educational and inspiring, offering practical insights into the concepts discussed during the presentations."

Flora & Habitat Observations

- Diverse Plant Species – Importance in maintaining ecosystem balance
- Mature Trees – Supporting epiphytic plants and vertical gardens
- Wildlife Information – Behavioural patterns and ecological roles

Lake Ecosystem Observed aquatic and semi-aquatic species habitat	Avifauna Multiple duck and waterfowl species observed along the trail
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Figure 6: Institute buildings showcasing eco-friendly architecture

During our campus tour, we observed the institute's impressive infrastructure designed to blend with the natural environment. The buildings feature sustainable construction materials and are positioned to minimize environmental impact. The campus demonstrates how modern research facilities can be developed while maintaining ecological sensitivity.

Design Philosophy

The institute's impressive infrastructure is **designed to blend with the natural environment**, featuring sustainable construction materials and strategic positioning to minimise environmental impact.

Sustainable Features

Solar Energy Renewable power generation through rooftop and ground installations	Natural Lighting Daylight optimisation reduces dependence on artificial lighting
Eco Materials Sustainable construction materials with low environmental footprint	Landscape Integration Harmony with nature through thoughtful landscaping

Key Learning The campus demonstrates how modern research facilities can be developed while maintaining ecological sensitivity, serving as a living example of sustainable architecture.

Design Education Connection

As UI/UX design students, observing WII campus design taught us practical lessons about sustainable architecture principles that can inform our approach to eco-conscious design solutions.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Learning Outcomes

Beyond the classroom: Six transformative insights

Interdisciplinary Perspective Gained appreciation for how design thinking can be applied to conservation challenges, including creating user-friendly interfaces for wildlife monitoring systems and developing educational materials.
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Research Methodology

Exposure to scientific research methodologies in conservation helped us understand the importance of data-driven decision making and systematic approaches to problem-solving.

Environmental Awareness

Enhanced understanding of environmental challenges, particularly the alarming rates of biodiversity loss, and the role of institutions in addressing them through research and community engagement.

Technology Integration

Learned how modern technology is integrated into conservation work, from camera traps and GPS tracking to digital databases and online platforms for data sharing.

Professional Development

Interaction with scientists provided insights into career opportunities at the intersection of design, technology, and conservation. Discovered how UI/UX skills create tools for environmental monitoring.

Sustainable Infrastructure

Observing WII campus design taught practical lessons about sustainable architecture, including solar energy, natural lighting, eco-friendly materials, and integration with natural landscapes.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Printed handouts or brochures on projects (Ganga Basin, JALAZ turtles) help students take home quick facts instead of scrambling for notes
- A part-time volunteer program for design/science students could let us contribute skills like app mockups for biodiversity data
- Creative project options (posters, app concepts, videos) over written reports suit design students perfectly.
- Shop section with AR previews of handmade products (home decor, edibles) to boost buys and stories.
- Quick video reels of field work or Praharis, TikTok-style, for easy sharing during GEU classes.

The Urgent Need for Action

69%

Terrestrial wildlife populations have declined since 1970

83%

Freshwater wildlife populations have declined since 1970

These sobering statistics serve as a powerful reminder of the urgent need for conservation action, motivating us to consider how our future professional work might contribute to environmental sustainability.



Figure 8: Graphic Era University students with faculty at Wildlife Institute of India

Our group photograph captures the successful completion of this educational field trip. Students from Graphic Era University, along with faculty members, gathered at the WII campus to commemorate this valuable learning experience. The enthusiasm and engagement visible in the photograph reflect the impact this visit had on all participants.

Conclusion

The academic field trip to the Wildlife Institute of India was an enriching and educational experience that went far beyond traditional classroom learning. It provided a unique opportunity to witness firsthand how scientific research and conservation efforts work together to protect India's natural heritage. The presentations by Dr. Deepika Dogra and Saurabh Sir were informative and inspiring, offering deep insights into river conservation and aquatic ecosystem management.

The nature trail component of the visit was particularly valuable, as it allowed us to connect theoretical knowledge with real-world observations. Seeing the diverse flora and fauna, understanding the complexity of ecosystem interactions, and experiencing the peaceful coexistence of research infrastructure with natural habitats left a lasting impression on all of us.

As UI/UX design students, this experience broadened our perspective on how our skills can contribute to meaningful causes beyond commercial applications. The visit demonstrated that good design can play a crucial role in conservation efforts, whether through creating intuitive data visualization tools for biodiversity monitoring, developing user-friendly educational applications for public awareness, designing effective communication materials for stakeholder engagement, or creating interactive platforms for citizen science initiatives.

The sobering statistics about biodiversity loss—with terrestrial populations declining by 69% and freshwater populations by 83% since 1970—serve as a powerful reminder of the urgent need for conservation action. Understanding these challenges has motivated us to consider how our future professional work might contribute to environmental sustainability and wildlife protection.

I am grateful to our teachers for organizing this visit and to the Wildlife Institute of India for hosting us and sharing their valuable knowledge and expertise. This experience has not only enhanced our academic understanding but has also inspired us to become more environmentally conscious designers and citizens.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Acknowledgment

Grateful appreciation to all who made this educational experience possible.

Institution Wildlife Institute of India, Dehradun	Presenters Dr. Deepika Dogra, Project Scientist; Saurabh Sir, JALAZ Project
Faculty Graphic Era Deemed to be University	Support Team Staff, guides, and fellow students